

GS Global Equities Call

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Here's what we're focused on this morning: SPX futs +11bps // NDX futs +2bps // 10YR +1bps @ 4.4138% // XBTUSD -200bps @ \$116k // WTI +32bps @ \$66.24. US markets calm as we head into a micro + macro packed week next week (see below), with little in the way of overnight headlines. Global equity markets choppy overnight (STOXX -29bps // FTSE -33bps // NIKKEI -38bps // HSI -109bps) ahead of next week's Aug 1 reciprocal tariffs deadlines + key central bank meetings. In Japan, Tokyo CPI fell by more than expected with core inflation below 3% for first time since March.

For today, watching: US Durable goods, Kansas City Fed Services

EPS: Pre CNC, PSX, HCA, AON, ERIE, CHTR

Earnings Movers:

FIX +14.4%: 2Q rev beat + raised dividend

DECK +12.4%: quarter is solid, with a big beat at both Hoka and Ugg, with upside to gross margins.

EW +6.6%: beat with WW TAVR results the standout

INTC -7.8%: Q2 better but tariff pull-ins helped and Q3 guide mixed with revenue better but EPS worse on lower GM from Lunar Lake ramp pressure

CNC -10% after an MLR miss (93% vs 91.6% est). Stock now -57% since the beginning of the month.

****WHAT WE'RE WATCHING:**

***Next Week:** S&P implied move through next Friday (8/1) is 1.51%. Health dose of micro + macro to watch for, with 37% of S&P market cap reporting (peak week of 2Q earnings) headlined by META + MSFT (Wed night) and AAPL + AMZN (Thurs night). On macro side, all eyes on FOMC (Wed // no cut currently priced in) + NFP/ISM (Friday) as well as the BOJ decision (Thurs). Look for headlines out of Bessent's trade talks with Chinese counterparts (Mon – Tues) ahead of the next tariff deadline on 8/1.

July 28 - Aug 1, 2025 – GS Week Ahead

Monday	Macro: Dallas Fed Manf, Bessent meeting with Chinese counterparts in Stockholm (through 7/29), Hong Kong Trade, \$69bn 2YR & \$70bn 5YR auctions
	Micro: EPS: Pre RVTY, BOH, EPD, // Post BRO, ED NS, CINF, HIG, NUE, PFG, UHS, VLTO, WELL, WM , BRX, KRC, OLN, WU, WWD
Tuesday	Macro: US merchandise Trade , Conference Board consumer confidence, JOLTS, Eurozone consumer inflation expectations, Dallas Fed Services, \$44bn 7YR auction
	Micro: EPS: Pre AMT, BA, CARR, CBRE, DTE, ECL, GL W, HUBB, INCY, JCI, MRK, NS C, PG, PYPL, RCL, SWK, SYY, UNH, UPS, JBLU, PII, PJT, SOFI, SPOT // Post BXP, CZR, EA, ESS, EXE, MDLZ, PPG, REG, RSG, SBUX, STX, TER, V, BKNG, CAKE, FRSH, PEB, QRVO, RRR
Wednesday	Macro: US GDP, ADP employment, pending home sales, BOC decision, Eurozone GDP & consumer confidence, Brazil rate decision, UST Quarterly refunding announcement
	Fed: FOMC decision
	Micro: EPS: Pre ADP, AEP, AMRN, AXTA, BG, CLVT, ENTG, ETSY, ETR, FTV, GEHC, GNRC, GRMN, H ES, HOG, HUM, HSY, IEX, ITW, KHC LXP, MO, ODFL, SF, SW, SMG, TEVA, TW, VFC, VIRT, VRT, WING, TT, V RSK, WEC, ZGN // Post ALB, ALL, AVB, AWK, AR, BHC, CFLT, CHRW, CTSH, CVNA, DXCM, EBAY, EG, EQIX, EX R, F, FE, FFIV, FICO, GFL, GH, HOLX, HST, INVH, IR T, LRCX, MAA, MCW, META , MGM, MSFT , PRU, PSA, PTC, QCOM, SFM, T YL, UDR, VICI, VTR, WDC
Thursday	Macro: US consumer income/spending, PCE price index, jobless claims, employment cost index, Canada GDP, China PMIs, Eurozone unemployment, BOJ decision
	Micro: AEVA investor day, EPS: Pre ABBV, ALGM, AME, APD, APTV, BAX, BIIB, BLDR, BMY, BWA, CI, CMCSA, CVS, D INO, EXC, GOOS, HII, HWM, ICE, IP, JHG, K, KIM, KKR, LNC, MA, MAS, MPW, NCLH, OWL, PCG, PPL, PWR, SHAK, SO, SPGI, TAL, UTZ, VMC, WTW, XEL, X PO, XYL // Post AAPL , AEE, AES, AJG, AMZN CL X, COIN, CPT, E IX, ES, HR, HUN, EMN, FSLR, IR , KLAC, LPLA, M ELI, MPWR, MTD, NOG, PK, PCOR, ROG, ROKU, RYAN, RMD, SYK, VALE
Friday	Macro: US NFP, S&P Global manufacturing PMI, ISM manufacturing, U Mich consumer sentiment, Eurozone CPI, Macau casino revs, UK trade, Trump tariff deadline

	Micro:EPS: Pre ARES, BTSG, BEN, CBOE, CHD, CL, CNH, CNK, CVX, D, GWW, KMB, LIN, LYB, MIR, MRNA, REGN, TROW, OSK, XOM
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GS GBM, as of 7/24/2025. Sources BBG, Street Account, GIR

***[Speculative Trading Indicator \(Snider\)](#):** Our Speculative Trading Indicator shows a recent increase in high-risk activity within the US equity market. The indicator is constructed based solely on trading volumes. Specifically, it is calculated as the indexed and re-scaled first principal component of monthly changes in the proportion of US public equity dollar trading value attributable to [1] unprofitable stocks, [2] penny stocks, and [3] stocks with EV/sales multiples greater than 10x. During the past month, the share of trading activity taking place in each of those three groups of stocks has ranked in the top quintile of activity since 1990.

- **In particular, recent US equity trading volumes have increasingly centered on high-multiple stocks.** The median EV/sales multiple of the 50 stocks with the highest share trading volumes, a simple measure that has historically tracked closely with the Speculative Trading Indicator, has also surged during the last few months. Today, that EV/sales multiple equals 8x, the highest level in recent decades outside of 2000 and 2021.

- **Call option volumes have surged alongside the increase in "speculative" cash trading volumes.** During the past month, calls have accounted for 61% of option volumes. This compares with a 20-year average of 55% and matches December 2024 as the highest share in a decade outside of the period from summer 2020 through early 2022.

- **In the past, sharp increases in speculative trading activity have signaled above-average near-term equity returns but a poor medium-term outlook for stocks.** We define "sharp increases" as 3-month increases of 15 points or more, a threshold reflecting roughly the top 5% of observations since 1990, but less than half the magnitude of the rise during the past few months. These above-average near-term returns have been accompanied by slightly higher near-term volatility and, more often than not, have eventually led to market drawdowns.

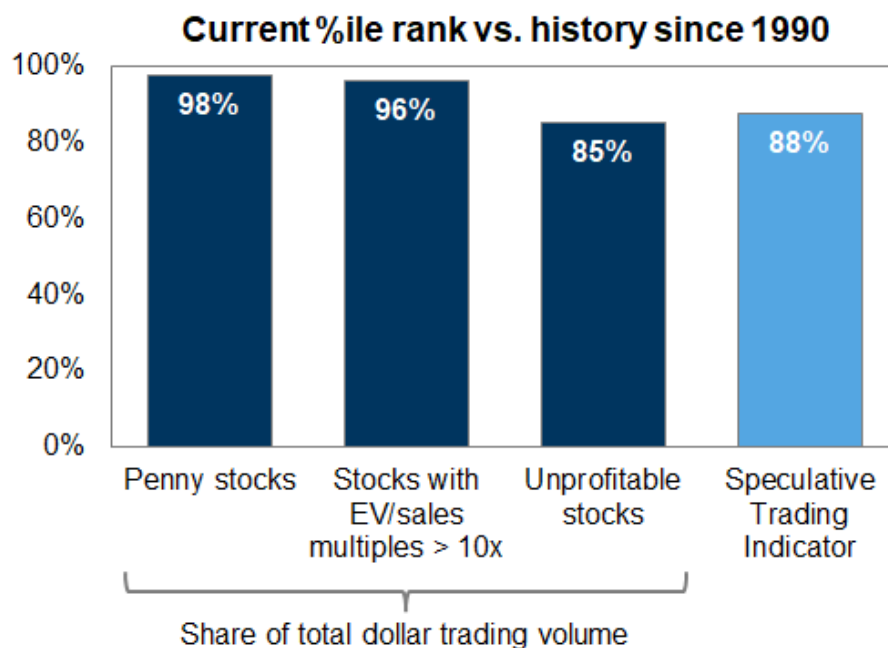
- **Recent positioning data and market internals indicate the potential for these recent rotations to continue.** Despite the S&P 500 sitting at record highs, our US equity [Sentiment Indicator](#) reflects neutral positioning on average across US equity investors. Likewise, after the large increase earlier this year, as of last week short interest for the median S&P 500 stock remained above the historical average and close to the highest level since 2019. As a result of these positioning dynamics, [market breadth](#) remains extremely narrow, a condition that typically signals risk to intra-market momentum.

Speculative Trading Indicator shows a recent increase in speculative activity



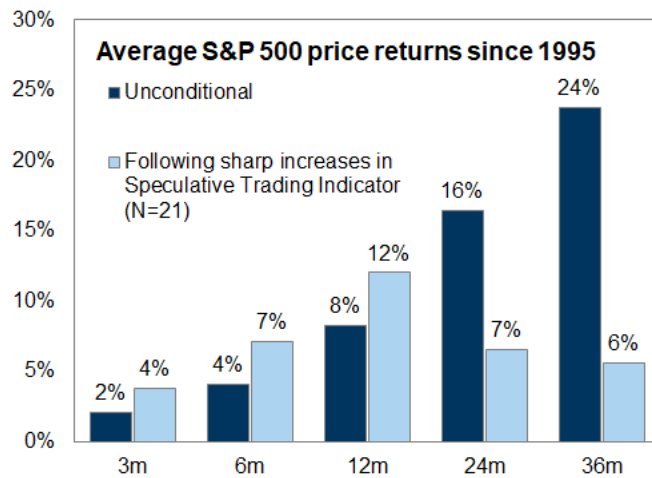
GIR, as of 7/24/2025. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Each component of the Speculative Trading Indicator screens as elevated vs. history



GIR, as of 7/24/2025. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

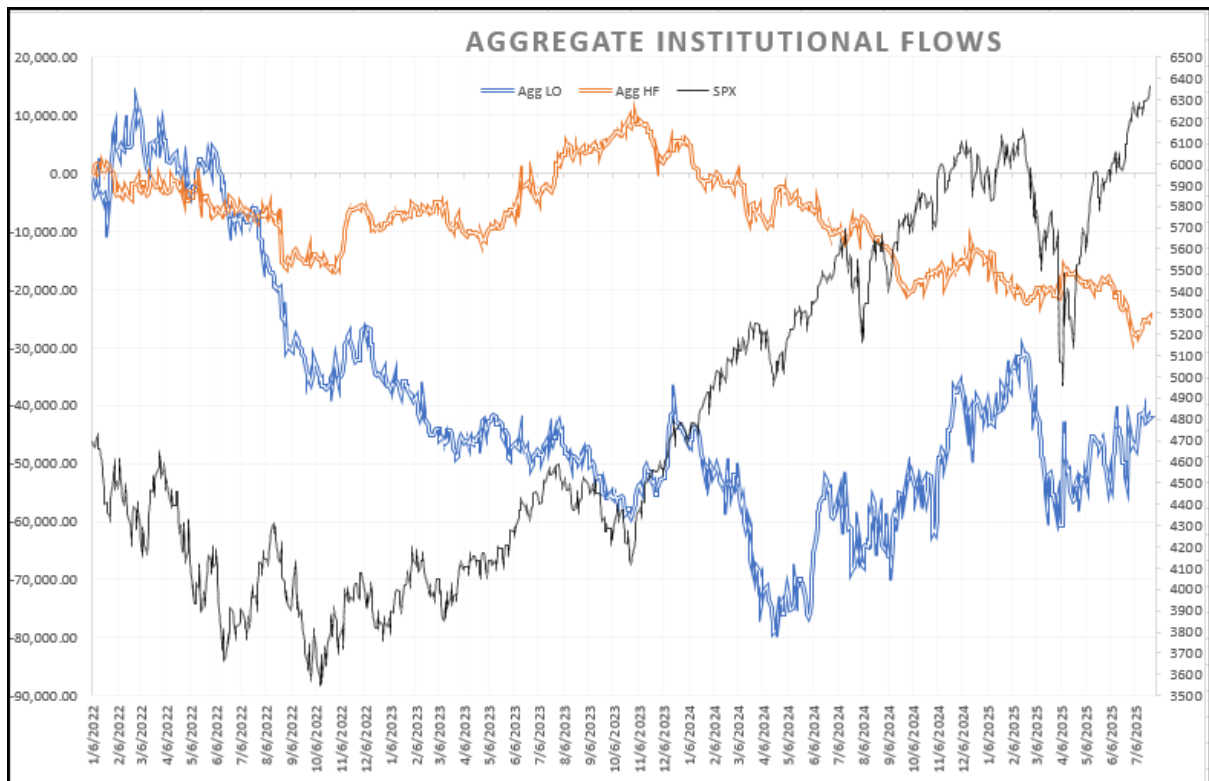
Sharp increases in speculative trading typically signal above-average short-term equity returns



GIR, as of 7/24/2025. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

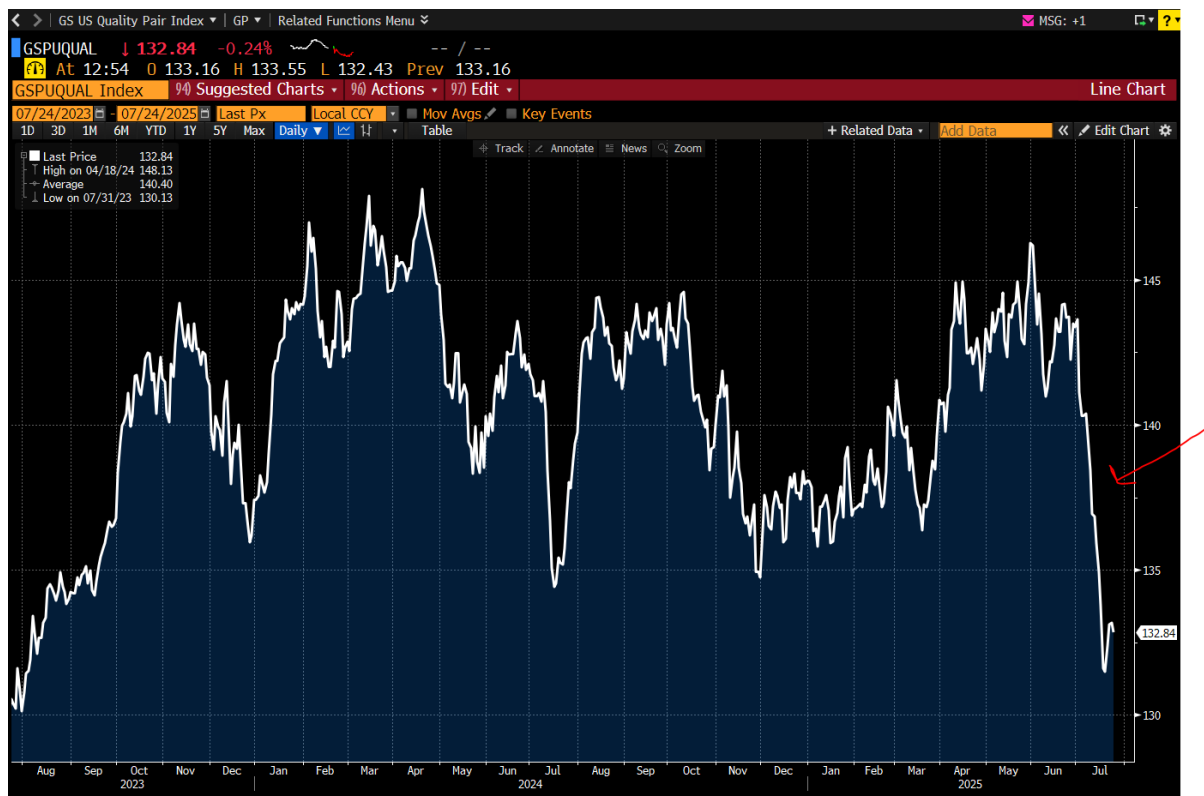
****STANDOUTS FROM YESTERDAY:**

***Flows:** Our floor was a 5 on a 1-10 scale in terms of overall activity levels. Our floor finished -340bps for Sale vs a 20day avg of +59bps. LOs finished ~flat with supply in tech and macro products vs demand in discretionary and industrials. HFs finished slight net sellers with supply in (short > long) in discretionary and macro products. On the week: LOs and HFs both screen ~flat as HFs traded around earnings on the heels of significant factor and crowding volatility under the hood + evidence of aggressive Retail participation. LOs remained in aggressive watch mode with some pronounced buying in tech. Largest Buy Skews: Tech, Staples, Discretionary // No sector was materially net sold.



GS GBM, as of 7/25/2025. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

***Chart of the day:** underneath a strong tape in July [yes, the NDX is (quietly) up ~250 bps in July] ... the drawdown in our QUALITY pair really stands out (10%+ drawdown) (h/t Pete Callahan)



Source; Bloomberg. GBM Public. 7/24/25. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

****SINGLES:**

Fins/REITs:

- **BAC:** Bank of America downgraded to Accumulate from Buy at Phillip Securities
- **BANC:** Banc of California price target raised to \$18 from \$17 at Keefe Bruyette
- **BX:** Blackstone price target raised to \$195 from \$180 at Citizens JMP
- **CGBD:** Carlyle Secured Lending upgraded to Overweight from Equal Weight at Wells Fargo
- **DB:** Deutsche Bank downgraded to Neutral from Outperform at Oddo BHF
- **DB:** Deutsche Bank downgraded to Sell from Neutral at Citi
- **ESQ:** Esquire Financial price target raised to \$110 from \$102 at Keefe Bruyette
- **HBNC:** Horizon Bancorp price target raised to \$18 from \$17 at Keefe Bruyette
- **JMSB:** John Marshall Bancorp price target raised to \$23 from \$22 at Keefe Bruyette
- **LOB:** Live Oak Bancshares price target raised to \$37 from \$36 at Keefe Bruyette
- **NDAQ:** Nasdaq price target raised to \$109 from \$101 at Barclays
- **SMBK:** SmartFinancial price target raised to \$38 from \$35 at Keefe Bruyette

- **SMBC:** Southern Missouri Bancorp price target raised to \$63 from \$60 at Keefe Bruyette
- **QCRH:** QCR Holdings price target raised to \$92 from \$90 at Keefe Bruyette
- **SLG:** SL Green Realty upgraded to Outperform from Sector Perform at Scotiabank
- **SLM:** SLM price target raised to \$43 from \$38 at Barclays
- **SNV:** Synovus downgraded to Equal Weight from Overweight at Wells Fargo
- **MSCI:** MSCI upgraded to Outperform from Market Perform at Raymond James
- **OSCR:** Baird downgrades Oscar Health on healthcare exchange uncertainty
- **NDAQ:** Nasdaq upgraded to Buy from Neutral at UBS
- **NDAQ:** Nasdaq price target raised to \$105 from \$97 at Deutsche Bank
- **GPN:** Global Payments upgraded to Outperform from Neutral at Mizuho

Industrials/Mats:

- **SMR:** NuScale Power initiated with Neutral at BNP Paribas Exane
- **SYM:** Symbotic downgraded to Neutral from Buy at Arete
- **OTIS:** Otis Worldwide upgraded to Peer Perform from Underperform at Wolfe Research
- **NSC:** Norfolk Southern downgraded to Hold from Buy at Jefferies
- **UNP:** Union Pacific upgraded to Buy from Hold at Jefferies
- **DOW:** Dow Inc. downgraded to In Line from Outperform at Evercore ISI
- **TECK:** Teck Resources downgraded to Neutral from Overweight at JPMorgan
- **ROL:** Rollins price target raised to \$60 from \$55 at Barclays

Energy/Utes:

- **EQNR:** Equinor downgraded to Hold from Buy at Pareto
- **OVV:** Ovintiv price target raised to \$57 from \$55 at Barclays
- **KMI:** Kinder Morgan upgraded to Outperform from Peer Perform at Wolfe Research
- **HESM:** Hess Midstream LP upgraded to Overweight from Equal Weight at Wells Fargo

Consumer:

- **DECK:** Deckers Outdoor price target raised to \$134 from \$128 at Barclays
- **CHD:** Church & Dwight price target raised to \$97 from \$92 at JPMorgan
- **CHDN:** Churchill Downs price target raised to \$131 from \$127 at Barclays
- **COUR:** Coursera upgraded to Neutral from Underperform at BofA
- **CVNA:** Carvana upgraded to Outperform from Perform at Oppenheimer
- **ENR:** Energizer price target raised to \$28 from \$27 at JPMorgan
- **ELF:** Elf Beauty price target raised to \$132 from \$123 at JPMorgan
- **ULTA:** Ulta Beauty downgraded to Hold from Buy at Loop Capital
- **LW:** Lamb Weston price target raised to \$68 from \$61 at Barclays

- **SN:** SharkNinja price target raised to \$144 from \$108 at JPMorgan
- **NWL:** Newell Brands price target raised to \$8 from \$7 at JPMorgan
- **VC:** Visteon price target raised to \$120 from \$115 at Barclays
- **TSLA:** Tesla downgraded to Hold from Buy at China Renaissance
- **PG:** Procter & Gamble downgraded to Neutral from Overweight at JPMorgan
- **EL:** Estee Lauder upgraded to Overweight from Neutral at JPMorgan
- **DAR:** Darling Ingredients downgraded to Neutral from Outperform at Baird
- **WH:** Wyndham Hotels price target raised to \$101 from \$100 at Barclays

Healthcare:

- **ICLR:** Icon price target raised to \$180 from \$155 at Barclays
- **CHE:** Chemed initiated with a Hold at Jefferies
- **TDOC:** Teladoc initiated with a Neutral at Mizuho
- **MOH:** Cantor downgrades Molina to Neutral on Medicaid uncertainty
- **SRPT:** Sarepta downgraded to Underweight from Neutral at JPMorgan
- **RCKT:** Rocket Pharmaceuticals downgraded to Neutral from Buy at BofA
- **LFST:** LifeStance initiated with a Buy at BTIG

TMT:

- **INTC:** Intel price target raised to \$22 from \$20 at Roth Capital
- **PTC:** PTC price target raised to \$225 from \$210 at Oppenheimer

**EARNINGS: EPS: Pre CNC, PSX, HCA, AON, ERIE, CHTR

Ticker	Sector	Price	Market Cap (\$M)	Next Report Date	Report Time	Implied Move	Positioning Score**	YTD
BAH	Industrials	\$109.33	\$13,566M	7/25/2025	Before Open	6.8%	3	-15.05%
SAIA	Industrials	\$288.10	\$7,673M	7/25/2025	Before Open	11.7%	4	-36.78%
LEA	Industrials	\$104.00	\$5,560M	7/25/2025	Before Open	1.9%	5	9.82%
GNTX	Industrials	\$22.94	\$5,157M	7/25/2025	Before Open	3.5%	3	-20.15%
WNC	Industrials	\$9.69	\$406M	7/25/2025	Before Open	7.4%	2	-43.43%
PSX	Energy/Utilities	\$125.90	\$51,296M	7/25/2025	Before Open	2.9%	3	10.51%
POR	Energy/Utilities	\$40.02	\$4,383M	7/25/2025	Before Open	3.6%	5	-8.25%
FCNCA	Financials	\$2,123.59	\$27,845M	7/25/2025	Before Open	6.0%	3	0.50%
AON	Financials	\$356.11	\$76,898M	7/25/2025	Before Open	3.4%	4	-0.85%
CNC	Healthcare	\$27.95	\$13,908M	7/25/2025	Before Open	7.7%	2	-53.86%
HCA	Healthcare	\$361.12	\$86,876M	7/25/2025	Before Open	4.4%	7	20.31%
CHTR	TMT	\$382.08	\$58,496M	7/25/2025	Before Open	7.4%	3	11.47%

GS GBM, as of 7/21/2025. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

**GS RATING AND CONVICTION LIST CHANGES:

Americas

Company Name	Tick er	Rating (New)	Rating (Old)	Today's Note
Boundless Bio Inc.	BOL D	Early-Stage Biotech?	-	Seeking commercial...
Arcutis Biotherapeutics Inc.	ARQ T	Neutral	-	Seeking commercial...

Source: Trade the News, Street Account, Bloomberg, GIR, GS GMD